



STUDY GUIDE

Western Vocals (MUSIC)

Category Overview

This category focuses on vocal agility, stylistic expression, and performance range through Western musical genres. Participants will have the opportunity to highlight their technical ability, control, dynamic variation, and artistic interpretation across contemporary, pop, rock, jazz, or classical Western music styles.

Overview:

Participants: Solo performances only

Accompaniment: Live instrumentalist from team (max 2 allowed) or pre-recorded backing track.

Genre: Song choice must be from Western Music Genres (e.g., Pop, Rock, Jazz, R&B, Soul, Blues, Country, Classical Western, etc.)

Rounds: 3 rounds (all elimination rounds with 3rd one serving as the final round)

Round 1 – Prelude (Audition Phase)

- Duration: 4 minutes
- Type: Elimination round
- Format: Participants perform one Western song of their choice. This round tests foundational vocal technique, pitch accuracy, tone quality, and comfort on stage

Round 2 – Harmony & Shift (Mash-up Challenge)

- Duration: 5 minutes
- Type: Elimination round
- Format: Qualifying participants perform a mashup combining contrasting Western genres or songs (e.g., Pop into Rock, R&B into Jazz, acoustic to uptempo). This round tests versatility, dynamic range, tempo control, and seamless musical transitions.

Round 3 – Crescendo (The Final)

- Duration: 5 minutes
- Format: Top finalists perform a complete Western showpiece, demonstrating peak vocal power, range, and stylistic depth. Judges will look for advanced vocal techniques (such as runs, riffs, vocal belts, head voice transitions), high-energy stage presence, and deep emotional connection.



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Judging Criteria:

- Pitch & Intonation Accuracy [10 points]: Precision in hitting correct notes and staying in key. Smooth vocal runs, riffs, and transitions without going sharp or flat.
- Vocal Expression & Tone [10 points]: Ability to convey the core emotion of the song (e.g., passionate, soulful, high-energy). Breath control, voice resonance, texture, and dynamic control (soft vs. powerful delivery).
- Stylistic Interpretation & Nuance [10 points]: Tasteful vocal dynamics, belt/head voice transitions, vocal extensions, and personal artistic nuance added while maintaining the integrity of the original song.
- Stage Presence & Confidence [10 points]: Body language, posture, movement, and emotional connection with the audience. Comfort on stage and engaging execution under live performance settings.
- Diction & Microphonic Technique [10 points]: Clear pronunciation and articulation of English lyrics. Effective microphone handling, timing, distance control, and overall polished delivery.

Note:

1. The decisions of the esteemed panel of judges will be final, binding, and uncontestable under any circumstances.
2. All song selections must feature appropriate lyrics suitable for a school environment. Any song containing explicit, offensive, or inappropriate language and themes will lead to immediate disqualification.